Arne Brasseur

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Principal Engineer | Founder | OSS Maintainer
Engineering veteran with 15+ years of experience driving technical strategy, specializing in Clojure/JVM and distributed systems. Prolific Open Source contributor and author of the industry-standard test runner for Clojure, Kaocha. I specialize in transforming ambiguous business needs into scalable technical architectures, while fostering a culture of documentation, testing, and engineering discipline.

Gaiwan | Founder and Head of Engineering (2019 — 2026)

Gaiwan was a boutique agency specializing in Clojure/ClojureScript, which grew out of my own contracting business. At the peak we were a team of seven engineers, delivering projects and augmenting teams across a handful of different clients.

At Gaiwan I wore many hats. I set the business strategy, did client acquisition, and managed and mentored the team.

On client engagements where we did team augmentation I would focus on enabling their existing teams, and on improving alignment between engineering and business stakeholders. On implementation projects I was responsible for capturing requirements, turning that into architecture, and making technical decisions that the team could build on. I would also often come back in towards the end of the project to do quality assurance and "last mile" delivery, making sure what we delivered was up to our own and the client's standards.

Gaiwan was bootstrapped, and was profitable every year that it operated, but worsening market conditions made us decide to wrap up the business to create space to explore new opportunities. Gaiwan applied for liquidation in Q3 2026.

Select Gaiwan projects I was involved in

Humble AI | Head of Engineering (2023 — 2026)
Humble initially built out several different prototype products to help them validate and find PMF. The lack of common foundation became a major hindrance.

Our initial engagement with Humble was a project to build out a Chrome browser extension. They soon thereafter started building out their engineering team, but lacked effective engineering leadership, leading to fragmented development, a lack of accountability, and a lack of control and transparency for the business.

Gaiwan stepped in to improve their engineering process, building out architectural, team management, and communication structure and practices.

I worked closely with the CEO and CTO to plan out engineering priorities. I worked closely with the engineering team to execute those priorities, and build out a winning engineering culture. I contributed several key pieces myself, including the foundations of their API and UI platform, an identity and auth layer, infrastructure automation, and dev and release tooling.

Transit | Engineering Lead (2022 — 2023)
Retail services

Establish a workflow based on BaseCamp's "Shape Up" methodology, and introduced best practices around communication and documentation. Delivered a "coupon code repository" component, used to issue and redeem retail coupons.

IT Revolution | Project Lead (2020 — 2023)
IT Revolution organises several high-profile industry events a year. The pandemic forced them to go virtual.

Deliver a multi-track video streaming solution, linked to their CMS (for access control) and Slack community, and a bespoke video editor and processing pipeline.

Eleven | Senior Engineer (2018 — 2022)
Eleven builds accounting software for accounting and wealth management firms

Eleven was in need of a BI solution they could offer to their customers. They commissioned me to build a Datomic connector for Metabase. Afterwards they moved to Datomic Analytics, but due to performance issues we built a Datomic ⟶ Postgres ingestion pipeline instead. (Plenish, open source).

Compute Software | Senior Engineer (2022)
Compute builds tools to help companies track and manage their cloud spend.

Develop a data pipeline and querying DSL to ingest and detailed GCP usage, and build up reports.

Nextjournal | Senior Engineer (2016 — 2020)
Nextjournal works on solving the research reproducibility crisis through a notebook interface backed by immutable environments.

Transition from Elixir to Clojure, and modernized tooling and stack. Worked on the execution engine, result rendering, and immutable representation of edit history.

Pre-Gaiwan projects

Lambda Island| Founder and author (2016 — 2019)
Educational resources (screencasts, articles) for Clojurists. Subscription based service.

Ticketsolve | Web Developer (2012 — 2015)
Ruby on Rails and Ember.js development for an Irish startup offering a e-commerce ticket sales solution for theaters, festivals, and events. Lead the frontend team through a reimplementation of the frontend as a responsive single-page application. Develop the API to power the frontend, based on the principles of Hypermedia as per Fielding

Telenet E-Sales | Web Developer (2010-2012)
Part of the team developing Telenet (Belgian telco) online shop

Harvard University, Archive of Japan's 2011 Disasters | Web Developer (2011)
Web app to collect testimonials after the earthquake and nuclear disaster, to enable scholarly research and analysis.

Kaizen, Win32/C port of z/OS Fileman | Systems Programmer (2009 — 2010)
Reimplement the FILEMAN functionality for the CA GEN CASE tool in C, so it can be used on Windows developer machines.

Lorré Engineering | C++ Developer (2006 — 2007)
Work on OCR/OMR systems used in medical laboratories.

Education

- Ghent University, BE | MSc Computer Science (magna cum laude) (2002-2006)
- Shandong University, CN | Mandarin language program (2008-2009)
- Fengchia University, TW | Mandarin language program (2007-2008)
- SAE Rotterdam, NL | Audio Engineering (2001-2002)

Notable Open Source

- **Kaocha** — de facto standard test runner for Clojure
- **Plenish** — convert Datomic triple-store representation to PostgreSQL, with automatic schema migration
- **Launchpad** — Clojure dev environment launcher
- **Ornament** — Clojure/ClojureScript styled components
- **Oak** — Identity provider with OAuth2.0/OIDC/JWT support
- **Compass** — conference program and workshop management tool
- **lambdaisland/uri** — idiomatic Clojure/ClojureScript URI library
- **Corgi** — opinionated Emacs configuration for Clojure developers
- **parseedn/parseclj** — Clojure/EDN parser library for Emacs Lisp
- **Piglet-lang** — ES6-based LISP implementation